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Product Design

2 research documents · each with plain-language key takeaways

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Design Foundation Master Plan — Storefront

(2026-06-15)

Source: readme/research/product-design/DESIGN_FOUNDATION_MASTER_PLAN_2026-06-15.md

IN SHORT — KEY TAKEAWAYS

This document is a step-by-step plan to make the online storefront look and feel like a premium, professional shop — not a generic website. It also lays the groundwork for features that keep customers coming back, like saving their designs. The plan is designed so several people (or AI agents) can work at the same time without getting in each other's way.

The main parts explained simply:

- **The core problem** — The storefront works well but does not look premium. Before adding new features, the visual design must be fixed properly, otherwise every new feature will need to be reworked three times (once per theme).
- **Design tokens** — Think of these as shared “knobs” that control colours, shadows, spacing, and text size across the whole site. When a block or section uses these shared knobs instead of hard-coding its own values, changing the store's brand colour automatically updates everything at once.
- **Three themes (default, aurora, prism)** — Three different visual styles a store owner can pick from. The plan fixes all three. The “aurora” theme is the biggest problem — it has thousands of lines of overriding styles that ignore the shared knobs, so store-wide colour changes don't apply to it.
- **CMS blocks** — Each section on a page (hero banner, product grid, testimonials, etc.) is a “block.” This plan sets a 7-point checklist every block must pass: registered correctly, has an admin preview, responds to the theme, shows loading/empty/error states, and uses plain language labels.
- **Waves (the order of work)** — Work is split into 5 phases: Wave 0 sets up safety nets and fixes a security gap. Wave 1 builds shared building-blocks used by all themes. Wave 2 updates every page section to use the shared knobs and polishes each theme. Wave 3 adds the “My Designs” library where customers can resume or reprint past orders. Wave 4 adds reminders, notifications, and recommendations.
- **Parallel workstreams** — Within each wave, different parts can be built at the same time by different agents, each owning a separate set of files so they never overwrite each other's work.
- **Open decisions for the founder** — Seven questions the business owner needs to answer before or during the work, such as: who approves what “premium” looks like, whether “My Designs” should launch behind a feature flag, and how deleted designs are handled after 30 days.

What to do with this: Read the open questions at the end and decide on each one before work starts — they are blockers. Then let Wave 0 run first; nothing else should start until the safety net and security fix are in place.

Goal: The storefront is fast and functional but does **not look premium**. Before building the shopper-retention roadmap (My Designs library, reprint reminders, notification feed), we fix the **design**

foundation across all 3 themes and make every section follow the **CMS block concept**. This plan is decomposed so **multiple agents can work in parallel without colliding**.

Produced by a multi-agent audit (theme system · block concept · design quality · retention surfaces)

- synthesis. Builds on `THEME_ARCHITECTURE_MIGRATION_2026-06-11.md` and the design-audit docs.

Strategy — Foundation-first

Every retention surface (My Designs page, “Pick up your designs” rail, future bell/feed) is just **another card-grid + block**. If we build them before the token/block foundation is solid, we’ll **re-fork them three times** (default/aurora/prism) and re-litigate the same ink-on-ink / padding-crush bugs on each theme.

The audits agree: **the system already exists and is good** — 78 `--theme-*` tokens, token-driven `.card` / `.btn--*`, `BaseButton` / `ProductCard` already migrated. The problems are:

1. **Consumption** — blocks hardcode radius/shadow/spacing/gray instead of consuming tokens.
2. **Aurora** — a 4039-line `!important` soup that is *not* token-driven and is **immune to per-store branding** (so “one color rebrands the store” is a silent lie on aurora).
3. **Stale block docs** — the CMS-block wiring SOP is wrong, so parallel agents would collide on the wrong files.

Design + blocks + retention **share the same currency**: `--theme-*` tokens + the compliant-block contract. Once tokens carry radius/shadow/spacing/type and the block contract is corrected and guarded, “*make design better*” and “*add a retention surface*” become the **same low-risk operation repeated** — not bespoke per-theme craft.

Three-theme model

- **default** = the north star (27 lines, token-values only) and the **frozen regression canary**. Never restyled — used to prove additive tokens are visually neutral.
- **Shared base** (SCSS/CSS, primitives, base block components) is built **once**; all three themes inherit it.
- **Per-theme look** is then a thin, parallel, **one-agent-per-theme** job of filling token *values* (prism polish, aurora de-soup) — never re-forking components.

Waves (execution order)

Wave	What	Workstreams (parallel within wave)	Gate to next wave
0 — Safety net + contracts	De-risk everything; almost no pixels change	W0-REG, W0-TOKENS, W0-SOP, W0-SEC, W0-DEAD	Baselines captured & green; tokens additive-neutral (default pixel-stable); SOP rewritten; customer-scope leak fixed+tested
1 — Shared foundation (built once)	Lifts all 3 themes at once	W1-PRIM, W1-PROSE, W1-ADMIN	Primitives render in <code>/preview/primitives</code> across all 3 themes; base <code>.prose</code> live; admin renderer globbed, zero blank previews
2 — Block sweep + per-theme look	Token-consumption sweep + theme polish	W2-BLOCKS-A, W2-BLOCKS-B, W2-THEME-DEFAULT (then PRISM, AURORA)	All 3 themes pass visual-regression at 375/768/1440; aurora collapsed & responds to brand.css; gray-bridge retired
3 — Retention Phase 1	My Designs library + rail (serialized pair)	W3-DESIGNS-PAGE → W3-DESIGNS-RAIL	Page + rail live, token-only, secure, 3 states, mobile-clean
4 — Retention Phases 2-4	Reminders, customer notification layer, recs/credit	W4-RETENTION (re-decomposed after Wave 3)	—

Workstreams (exclusive file ownership)

Wave 0 — all parallel, ~no pixel change

- **W0-REG** (L) — Visual-regression + a11y harness + `/preview` galleries.
 - Owns: `frontstore/app/pages/preview/primitives.vue`, `.../preview/blocks.vue`, `frontstore/tests/e2e/theme/visual-regression.spec.ts`, `.../preview-axe.spec.ts`, `frontstore/playwright.config.ts` (visual project + baselines only).
- **W0-TOKENS** (M) — Additive token expansion (type scale `--text-h1..body/label`, `--theme-section-spacing`, aspect-ratio, confirm radius/shadow). **Strictly additive**, defaults == current values.
 - Owns: `frontstore/theme-styles/base/storefront.scss`.
- **W0-SOP** (M) — Rewrite stale `CMS_BLOCK_SOP.md` to real wiring; codify 7-point compliance gate; eslint rule banning new hardcoded `bg-* -NNN` / `text-* -NNN` + visual scoped `<style>` in base blocks; extend color-budget ratchet.
 - Owns: `readme/CMS_BLOCK_SOP.md`, `frontstore/eslint config` (restricted-syntax rule only), `frontstore/scripts/check-color-budget.mjs`.

- **W0-SEC (M) — Security prerequisite.** Re-enable `applyContextScope` in `DesignerController::getDesigns` (~line 198) and `getDesign` (~line 231). `DesignResource` returns human name (design → product → “Untitled design”, never UUID) + `updated_at`. Feature test: customer A cannot read customer B’s design.
 - Owns: `app/Http/Controllers/Api/Storefront/DesignerController.php`, `app/Http/Resources/Api/Storefront/DesignResource.php`, `tests/Feature/Storefront/DesignCustomerScopeTest.php`.
- **W0-DEAD (S) —** Delete `frontstore/app/utils/brandTokens.ts` (confirm zero importers); remove unused `store_themes` color columns/resource fields; fix `StoreThemeController::reset()` 500 (calls `applyPreset('modern')` which doesn’t exist).
 - Owns: `frontstore/app/utils/brandTokens.ts`, `app/Http/Controllers/Api/Store/StoreThemeController.php`, `app/Http/Resources/Api/Store/StorefrontThemeResource.php`.

Wave 1 — shared foundation, all parallel

- **W1-PRIM (L) —** Named primitives (`AppButton` / `AppInput` / `AppSelect` / `AppTab` / `AppQtyStepper`) + new shared retention primitives (`RailShell` , `DesignCard` , `ActionMenu` , `ConfirmDialog`). All token-driven, zero per-theme hooks. Depends: W0-TOKENS, W0-REG.
 - Owns: `frontstore/app/components/storefront/ui/{AppButton,AppInput,AppSelect,AppTab,AppQtyStepper,RailShell,ActionMenu,ConfirmDialog}.vue`, `frontstore/app/components/storefront/profile/DesignCard.vue`.
- **W1-PROSE (M) —** Install `@tailwindcss/typography` scoped to `.storefront-layout`; one token-driven base `.prose`; collapse `blog/[slug].vue` fork; fix bare `[slug].vue` prose. Depends: W0-TOKENS.
 - Owns: `frontstore/package.json`, `frontstore/nuxt.config.ts`, `frontstore/app/pages/[slug].vue`, `frontstore/app/pages/blog/[slug].vue`.
- **W1-ADMIN (L) —** Convert `nuxt/.../store/BlockRenderer.vue` from 50 static imports to glob (parity w/ frontstore); backfill ~10+ missing admin previews. Depends: W0-SOP.
 - Owns: `nuxt/app/components/store/BlockRenderer.vue`, `nuxt/app/components/store/blocks/`, `nuxt/app/utils/blockPreviewSamples.ts`, `nuxt/app/components/store/BlockSampleHint.vue`.

Wave 2 — block consumption + per-theme look

- **W2-BLOCKS-A (L) —** Commerce blocks: Hero/FeaturedProduct/ProductGrid/BestSellers/ShopByCategory/NewArrivals → tokens/primitives, shadow-theme only, section-spacing, AppButton, skeletons mirror aspect-ratio, 3 states. Depends: W1-PRIM, W1-PROSE.
- **W2-BLOCKS-B (L) —** Content blocks: Testimonial/Newsletter/FeatureList/Faq/CtaBanner/Stats/TrustBadges (+ cms util set). Disjoint file set

from A. Depends: W1-PRIM, W1-PROSE.

- **W2-THEME-DEFAULT** (S) — **Not a restyle**. Frozen canary; verify pixel-stable; add token values only if a new base token needs an explicit default. Depends: W0-TOKENS.
 - Owns: `frontstore/theme-styles/default/theme.scss` .
- **W2-THEME-PRISM** (M) — Tighten prism (1046 lines / 54 `!important`) toward token-values-only; clean brand ramp from `--brand-primary` ; keep 3 data-personality variants. Depends: W2-BLOCKS-A/B.
 - Owns: `frontstore/theme-styles/prism/theme.scss` , `frontstore/app/themes/prism/` .
- **W2-THEME-AURORA** (L) — **The big one**. Collapse aurora (4039 lines / 1092 `!important` / 431 `[class*=]`) toward ~30-80 token-value lines; derive palette from `--theme-color-*` via color-mix so brand.css recolors aurora; de-fork 11 component forks (keep only structural ones thin via shared composables). Every step gated by W0-REG suite. Depends: W2-BLOCKS-A/B, W0-REG.
 - Owns: `frontstore/theme-styles/aurora/theme.scss` , `frontstore/app/themes/aurora/` .

Wave 3 — retention Phase 1 (serialized pair)

- **W3-DESIGNS-PAGE** (L, run first) — `profile/designs.vue` mirroring `wishlist.vue` grid; `DesignCard` + `ActionMenu` (Resume/Reprint/Make a copy/Delete) + `ConfirmDialog` ; Recently-deleted sub-view (Restore); ProfileSidebar entry; extend `useDesignerApi` (delete/restore/duplicate + claim-on-login). Depends: W0-SEC, W1-PRIM.
 - Owns: `frontstore/app/pages/profile/designs.vue` (+ `designs/`), `frontstore/app/composables/storefront/useDesignerApi.ts` , `routes/frontstore.php` (designer recently-deleted/restore/duplicate), `tests/Feature/Storefront/DesignClaimOnLoginTest.php` , `ProfileSidebar.vue` .
- **W3-DESIGNS-RAIL** (M, run second) — `PickUpDesignsBlock.vue` (modeled on `RecentlyViewedBlock`): customer-scoped fetch, RailShell + `DesignCard`, auto-hide via `emit('no-content')` , 3 states, token-only. Register as a **compliant block** (`blockTypes.ts` schema + admin preview + same key). Consumes `useDesignerApi` read-only. Depends: W0-SEC, W1-PRIM, W1-ADMIN, W0-SOP.
 - Owns: `frontstore/app/components/storefront/blocks/PickUpDesignsBlock.vue` , `nuxt/app/components/store/blocks/MyDesignsRailBlock.vue` .

Wave 4 — retention Phases 2-4 (re-decompose after Wave 3)

Opt-in observed-interval reprint reminders; **new customer-recipient notification layer** (existing Notification is admin/User-only) → customer bell + activity feed; server-side recently-viewed / recs / store credit. Each new surface is a compliant block or account page reusing W1 primitives — no per-theme forks.

Collision rules (so parallel agents never conflict)

1. **Exclusive ownership** — each workstream's `ownsFiles` is its sole edit territory for its wave. No two parallel streams in a wave share a file.
 2. **Base SCSS is single-owner** — `theme-styles/base/storefront.scss` owned only by W0-TOKENS, then the design lead. Block/theme agents **consume** tokens, never edit base. New shared class = a serialized base-only commit *between* waves.
 3. **Token names are a public API** — `brand.css` + `injectThemeHtml` SSR plugin depend on exact `--theme-*` names. No renames (deprecation cycle only). W0-TOKENS only ADDS, defaults == current.
 4. **SSR plugin single-owner** — `frontstore/server/plugins/injectThemeHtml.server.ts` (brand-after-theme-before-custom order) touched by ≤1 stream at a time; high blast radius (cross-tenant brand leak).
 5. **Admin BlockRenderer collision eliminated by W1-ADMIN** (glob conversion). Until it merges, block work that would touch it is blocked behind W1-ADMIN.
 6. **blockTypes.ts split protocol** — hot shared file. Wave 3: only W3-DESIGNS-RAIL registers a new type. Multiple later streams → append-only edits (each appends its block object at the end, never reformat) OR split the registry into per-category modules first (recommended one-time refactor in Wave 1).
 7. **Data-bound block key pairing** — a data-bound block adds its key in **both** `CmsBlockRenderer.resolvedProps` AND `StorePageService::resolveBlockDataFromModel`, in one commit by the single introducing stream (W3-DESIGNS-RAIL).
 8. **ProfileSidebar.vue** edited only by W3-DESIGNS-PAGE.
 9. **W3 pair serialization** — `useDesignerApi` assigned exclusively to W3-DESIGNS-PAGE; rail consumes read-only. Run page first so methods exist before the rail uses them.
-

CMS block compliance — the 7-point gate (every new/changed section)

1. **Defined once** — registered in `blockTypes.ts` with full `settings_schema`, sensible defaults, correct category, honest `supports_data_binding` / `supports_conditions`.
2. **Admin preview exists** — `nuxt/.../store/blocks/{Type}Block.vue` resolvable (post-W1-ADMIN: auto-globbed). Empty → `blockPreviewSamples` + `StoreBlockSampleHint`, never blank.
3. **Frontstore block auto-resolves** — `frontstore/.../blocks/{Name}Block.vue` (PascalCase + `Block`, NOT `SectionXxx`), `defineProps<{settings, styles}>`, resolved by `useComponentResolver` glob — no map edit.
4. **Same-key end-to-end** — identical settings keys in schema, admin preview, frontstore block; proven by placing a value and seeing it render. Data-bound → key in both renderer + `StorePageService`.
5. **Theme-correct without forking** — consume `--theme-*` tokens + shared primitives. No hardcoded `bg-* -NNN` / `text-* -NNN` (eslint), no raw `shadow-lg/xl/2xl` (shadow-theme-* only), no scattered

`rounded-2xl/3xl` (rounded-card/button/input). Fork = documented exception.

6. **All three states** — skeleton mirrors final aspect-ratio (no jump); empty → `emit('no-content')` collapses section padding; error contained by per-block `NuxtErrorBoundary`. Never blank/raw-error/untranslated key.
7. **Non-technical + responsive** — plain-language labels (human names from content, never UUID/"textbox"); clean at 375/768; destructive actions confirm with stated consequences via shared `ConfirmDialog`.

How to run with agents

- **Fan-out:** one agent per workstream ID in the wave, each given **only** its `ownsFiles` + compliance + collision rules.
- **Worktree isolation REQUIRED** for any wave running 2+ parallel streams. Branch each worktree from the **same verified HEAD** of `store-theme-change` — **explicitly pass the base SHA and verify merge-base before merging** (per the known agent-worktree-base bug). File-exclusive ownership makes merges conflict-free by construction.
- **CI gate between every wave:** Playwright visual-regression + axe/contrast at 375/768/1440 across all 3 themes, color-budget ratchet, eslint no-hardcoded-color. A wave doesn't open until green.
- **Aurora gets the longest leash** and must run against the W0-REG suite on every commit (431 broad selectors over-match).
- **Wave 3 is NOT fanned out** — run W3-DESIGNS-PAGE to completion (owns `useDesignerApi` + `ProfileSidebar`), then W3-DESIGNS-RAIL.
- Recycle `dev:all` workers after any token/config change (doesn't auto-restart).

Open questions for the founder (decide before/while executing)

1. **blockTypes.ts** — accept append-only edits to the 1688-line monolith, or split into per-category modules in Wave 1? (*Recommended: split, since Phases 2-4 register several blocks.*)
2. **Gray-bridge retirement** — end of Wave 2 (after all blocks consume tokens) vs a dedicated cleanup wave; add dark on-surface tokens in W0-TOKENS or a follow-up?
3. **Aurora de-fork QA** — is there a live aurora tenant to verify server-side resolution against, or do we stand one up? (The migration log's injection-simulation never verified real SSR.)
4. **Customer notification layer (Phase 3)** — confirm a customer-scoped *sibling* system (not retrofitting admin Notification); is the activity feed an account page, a CMS block, or both?
5. **My Designs delete semantics** — confirm Delete = soft-delete to Recently-Deleted, 30-day window (stated in confirm copy); who purges after 30 days (scheduled job)?
6. **Visual-regression baseline authority** — who signs off the first baselines as "correct premium"? Every later wave is gated against them, so a wrong baseline locks in a wrong look.

7. **Feature flag** — ship My Designs behind a flag until Phase 1 (claim-on-login + recently-deleted) is complete, per §0 “no half-built UI”?

Storefront Design / Professionalism Audit - 2026-06-07

Source: [readme/research/product-design/STOREFRONT_DESIGN_AUDIT_2026-06-07.md](#)

IN SHORT — KEY TAKEAWAYS

This document is a full review of how your online store looks to customers — every page, every section. A team of design specialists checked 38 pages and scored each area. The verdict: everything works, but the store looks plain and unfinished compared to top print and e-commerce sites like Moo or Vistaprint. The good news is that four fixable problems cause almost all of it, so fixing them lifts the whole site at once.

The main parts explained simply:

- **Why it looks “basic” (the root causes)** — Four things make the store feel flat and cheap: everything is the same visual level with no shadows or depth; headings and body text look almost the same size; most pages ignore the shared style rules and invent their own styles instead; and spacing between sections is random. Fix these four things and every page improves automatically.
- **Page-by-page scores** — Six groups of pages were graded. The style foundation (shared design rules) scored 4 out of 10. The homepage and site header scored 5. The blog, contact, and form pages scored 5. Product browsing and product detail pages scored 6. The cart and checkout scored 6. Login and account pages scored 6. Nothing scored above 6 — all for the same reasons.
- **Shadows and card depth** — Right now almost everything sits on a flat white surface. Professional shops use subtle drop shadows so buttons and cards appear to “lift” off the page. Adding this one effect everywhere makes the site feel modern and trustworthy.
- **Text sizes and label styles** — Headings need to look clearly bigger and bolder than body text, so customers can scan a page easily. Labels on forms (“Name”, “Email”) are too small and faint right now — they almost disappear.
- **Shared building blocks (design system)** — The store has a good set of shared style rules already written. The problem is that 53 page sections ignore those rules and use their own styles instead, so the site looks like 20 different designs stitched together. Migrating sections to use the shared rules is the single biggest fix.
- **Spacing rhythm** — The gap between sections jumps from small to very large with no consistent pattern. Setting one standard spacing size for all sections makes the page feel calm and professional.
- **Quick wins** — Many improvements take under an hour each: adding drop shadows to cards so they lift on hover, making form labels bigger, improving the hero banner at the top of the homepage, and fixing the blog pages so text is readable.
- **Strategic upgrades (bigger effort)** — Longer work includes building a proper set of reusable components (status badges, product cards, empty-state messages) that all pages share, and making mobile layouts feel as polished as desktop.
- **Page-load feel (logo click lag)** — Clicking the store logo feels slow because the homepage waits for data before showing anything. Fixing this so the page shows a loading skeleton immediately would make the store feel much faster, even before any design changes.

What to do with this:

Start with the four root causes — shadows/depth, text sizing, shared style rules, and consistent spacing. These are quick to apply and will make every page look noticeably more professional within days, without redesigning anything from scratch.

Multi-agent design audit of the customer storefront (`frontstore/` , Nuxt 4 + Tailwind). Trigger: owner feedback - “all features work but the design looks basic / not professional.” Method: 6 specialist agents (one per page-group + design system) + 1 synthesis pass. All 38 pages + global shell + design system reviewed. Benchmark feel: Myntra, Vistaprint, Moo, Shopify premium themes, Stripe-grade polish.

Root cause - why it reads as “basic”

Not one bad page - all six areas scored 4–6/10 for the *same four compounding reasons*:

1. **Depth is flat.** Almost everything sits on `shadow-sm` + `border-gray-100` → the whole site looks like one flat sheet. Premium shops earn their feel through elevation hierarchy + hover-lift. Biggest single gap.
2. **Weak type hierarchy.** Headings/body/labels too close in size+weight. Labels are `text-xs font-medium text-gray-600` everywhere (they vanish); hero jumps `text-sm` → `text-7xl`.
3. **Design system broken at the consumption layer.** `storefront.css` has a *good* token system, but **53 blocks ignore it**: 257 hardcoded paddings, 92 inline `rounded-*`, 7 competing shadow conventions, raw `<button>` instead of `AppButton`. Feels like 20 designs stitched together.
4. **Arbitrary spacing.** Section padding `py-8` → `py-20`, no rhythm.

Implication: fix depth + type + component consistency *systemically* and every page lifts at once - no need to redesign 38 pages.

Per-area scorecard

Area	Score	Verdict
Design system (tokens/primitives)	4/10	Great token foundation, but blocks ignore it - root cause of everything else
Homepage & global shell	5/10	Cramped header, flat hero with no depth, arbitrary section rhythm, dense footer
Content/marketing & forms	5/10	Bare unstyled blog/CMS prose, raw-Tailwind 404/maintenance, inconsistent fields
Product discovery & detail	6/10	Good bones; fragmented hover/quick-view, mixed glassmorphism, one-off filter/sort
Conversion funnel (cart/checkout)	6/10	Complete but weak depth; order summary cramped, success page under-celebrated
Login & account	6/10	Works but minimal - flat cards, scattered inline badges, admin-style tables

Top 10 highest-impact changes (impact ÷ effort, systemic first)

1. **Extend Tailwind with `shadow-theme-*` + `rounded-card/button/input` utilities, then enforce ONE shadow/radius system.** `frontstore/nuxt.config.ts` Tailwind `extend`, then sweep `app/components/storefront/blocks/*`. Add a CI grep guard. *Biggest lever.* (hours)

```
extend: {
  boxShadow: { 'theme-sm': 'var(--theme-shadow-sm)', 'theme-md': 'var(--theme-shadow-md)', 'theme-lg': 'var(--theme-shadow-lg)' },
  borderRadius: { card: 'var(--theme-card-radius)', button: 'var(--theme-button-radius)', input: 'var(--theme-input-radius)' },
}
```

2. **Real type scale + label standard.** `--text-h1/h2/body` tokens; headings `font-bold`, labels → `text-sm font-semibold text-gray-900` with styled required `*`; hero `leading-[1.1] tracking-tight`. (low)
3. **Card elevation + hover-lift everywhere.** Resting `shadow-theme-sm border border-gray-100`, interactive `hover:shadow-theme-lg hover:-translate-y-1 transition-all duration-200`; accent/active cards `shadow-theme-lg`. Make blocks use `AppCard` (currently used in 0 blocks). (medium)
4. **Install `@tailwindcss/typography` + style `.prose`.** Fixes all blog/CMS pages (`blog/[slug].vue`, `[slug].vue`). `max-width: 65ch`, heading contrast, `line-height:1.75`. (~1 hr, 80% fix from one package)
5. **Migrate blocks to `AppButton` / `AppInput`** - kill raw inline buttons. Start `FormBlock`, `DynamicFormBlock`, `ProductGridBlock`, `PageHeaderBlock`, `BestSellersBlock`. Core consistency

fix. (medium, incremental)

6. **Redesign the hero** (`HeroBlock.vue`) - text-shadow, replace busy `ping` + `pulse` badge with one scale-pulse, visible bordered nav arrows, subtle gradient backdrop instead of flat `#f8f8f8` , CTA `shadow-theme-lg hover:scale-105` . (hours)
7. **One `StatusBadge.vue`** (`app/components/storefront/ui/`) driven by `statusColor` util - replaces hand-rolled status colors across `profile/index.vue` , `profile/orders/*` , `profile/quotes/*` , track-order. (~0.5 day)
8. **Upgrade checkout Order Summary + step indicators** (`CheckoutSummary.vue` , `CheckoutSectionCard.vue` , `cart.vue`) - total `text-2xl→text-3xl` , roomier padding, subtle gradient, active step `w-10→w-12` + `shadow-theme-lg` , completed steps green, animated connector. (hours)
9. **Standardize section rhythm** - all major sections `py-12 md:py-16` , consistent `px-4 md:px-6 lg:px-8` . Define `--section-spacing-*` tokens. (low, mechanical)
10. **Polish empty states + input focus states globally** - empty-state icon circles `bg-gradient-to-br from-primary-50 to-primary-100` + encouraging copy + CTA; all inputs `focus:ring-2 focus:ring-primary-500 transition-all` , darken leading icons to `text-gray-500` ; migrate login/signup raw `<input>` to `BaseInput` . (low-medium)

Quick wins (this week - mostly minutes each)

1. Tailwind `shadow-theme-*` + `rounded-card/button/input` utilities (#1 foundation) - 20 min.
 2. `@tailwindcss/typography` + base `.prose` - 1 hr; fixes all blog/CMS.
 3. Hero text-shadow + replace `ping` badge + visible nav arrows - 30 min.
 4. Form labels `text-xs font-medium` → `text-sm font-semibold text-gray-900` + styled required `*` (login, profile, checkout, contact, quote).
 5. `focus:ring-2 focus:ring-primary-500 transition-all` on every `BaseInput` ; leading icons → `text-gray-500` .
 6. Card hover-lift on product/profile-stat/contact/blog/address cards.
 7. Category card lift `-translate-y-1` → `-translate-y-3` , zoom `700ms→500ms` (`ShopByCategoryBlock`).
 8. CheckoutSummary padding/total bump; active step `w-10→w-12` + `shadow-theme-lg` .
 9. Order-success headline → green gradient `bg-clip-text` ; hero icon `w-28→w-32` + `shadow-theme-lg` .
 10. Promo bar → `bg-primary-600 text-white` ; section padding `py-12 md:py-16` .
 11. Table row hover `hover:bg-primary-50/30` + uppercase tracked headers (profile orders/quotes).
 12. Fix `BaseSelect.vue:6` hardcoded `border-gray-200` → token; replace `bg-primary/10` opacity hacks with `--theme-primary-background` token.
 13. Replace one-off review "View product" `BaseButton !px-0` hack with `.theme-link` .
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Strategic upgrades (premium tier)

1. **Execute** `DESIGN_SYSTEM_STANDARDIZATION_PLAN.md` **Phases 0–2** (drafted, never started): codify “blocks must use App*/Base* primitives” in `copilot-instructions.md`, add CI grep guards, build `/pages/dev/design-system.vue` preview, migrate top 5–10 blocks. Cure for the “20 designs” problem. (~2 wks)
 2. **Semantic color + type vocabulary layer** - promote `.text-secondary/.text-muted/.bg-surface-soft/.text-h1/.text-body` to first-class utilities; sweep blocks off raw `text-gray-700 / text-sm`. (~30 hrs)
 3. **Refactor Aurora theme to token-only** - strip ~4000 lines of selector overrides to ~50 lines of `:root` vars; future themes become an afternoon. (~40 hrs)
 4. **Reusable component set** - `StatusBadge`, `AppCard / GlassCard`, `ProductCardTitle`, `FilterCountBadge`, `PriceRangeInput`, `SortBySelect`, `ReviewCard`, `EmptyState`, `PremiumTable`, `AnimatedTabs`.
 5. **Product card + PDP gallery hover/state overhaul** - unify quick-view pill (→ `AppButton`), wishlist, card lift into one `.product-card-hover`; simplify gallery thumbnail state logic to a clean three-state machine.
 6. **Checkout depth + micro-interaction pass** - layered shadows per section state, focus-ring animations, `active:scale-95`, success-checkmark scale-in.
 7. **Skeleton parity** - every skeleton mirrors its final card aspect-ratio to kill the load-time jump; standardize on `animate-shimmer`.
 8. **Mobile premium pass** - header `h-14→h-16/h-20`, bottom nav `h-16→h-20` + `font-semibold`, 44px min tap targets, `backdrop-blur bg-white/95` nav.
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Related finding - perceived performance (logo-click lag)

Separate from visuals but the same theme (“finish the small interactions”). Clicking the logo feels dead for a moment because `app/pages/index.vue:104-108` does a **blocking top-level** `await` (`useAsyncData('homepage-data', ..., { lazy: false })` + `await Promise.all`). On client-side navigation `<NuxtPage>` won’t swap pages until that fetch resolves, so the old page stays on screen with no feedback.

Fix: (1) make the homepage fetch `lazy: true` + render existing skeletons (`app/components/storefront/skeletons`); (2) add a global `<NuxtLoadingIndicator>` so every nav gives instant top-bar feedback; (3) sweep other pages (category, product, search) for the same `lazy: false` + top-level `await` pattern.

Source: workflow `storefront-design-audit` (run `wf_9681fd8d-aec`), 7 agents, 2026-06-07.